

**SCORE**  
**BOARD** Specifications

| The PIM Feature               |                            |          |                        |           |                         |        |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------|----------|------------------------|-----------|-------------------------|--------|
| Name                          | Web site                   | Price    | Integrated mail client | Organizer | Advanced Phone Features | Rating |
| Corel Infocentral 7           | www.corel.com              | Rs 4,600 | No                     | No        | Yes                     | B      |
| Cute Organizer                | www.kaboom.org.uk          | Rs 700   | Yes                    | Yes       | No                      | C+     |
| Cybercontact                  | www.liraz.com/cybercontact | Free     | Yes                    | Yes       | No                      | C+     |
| Day Timer Organizer 2000      | www.daytimer.com           | Rs 3,000 | No                     | Yes       | Yes                     | B      |
| Electronic Assistant Lite 4.0 | www.danteproductions.com   | Rs 1,000 | No                     | Yes       | No                      | B      |
| Epoch Organizer               | www.kaboom.org.uk          | Rs 700   | Yes                    | Yes       | No                      | B-     |
| Lotus Organizer 6             | www.lotus.com              | Rs 3,760 | No                     | Yes       | No                      | B+     |
| Microsoft Outlook 2002        | www.microsoft.com          |          | Yes                    | No        | No                      | A-     |
| RedBox 4.0                    | www.inklineglobal.net      | Rs 450   | No                     | Yes       | No                      | B+     |

through Microsoft Outlook. It also allows you to export to CSV, which is one of the most widely used formats around the world. Other PIMs like RedBox Organizer also support TXT and CSV import and export. Day Timer 2000, on the other hand, uses ASCII and Text values for its import and export functions. Like CSV, there also exist other formats such as VCard and VCalendar, which are used widely by Microsoft applications. VCard and VCalendar are special file formats that allow you to keep huge databases of contacts and appointment lists.

**Ease of use**

One of the easiest software to use was **Lotus Organizer 6.0**. Its interface is designed like a diary. The multi-tab structure makes navigation really simple, and you can change views at the click of a button. RedBox Organizer's interface is somewhat similar to that of the Lotus Organizer. RedBox has big buttons on the interface, which allow you to switch from

one feature to another. There is a Show Me How button at the top left corner of the window, which you can use to learn how to do a particular task, with the help of a pop-up window.

In Microsoft Outlook, views can be changed through the various options in the View menu, such as enabling and disabling the Preview window, etc.

Outlook also has the immensely unpopular Clippy to help you out in doing particular tasks. The features have self-explanatory icons on the interface. Outlook Today allows you to view a summary of your calendar, pending tasks and inbox.

**CONCLUSION**

After going through the entire gamut of products, the winners were not difficult to pick—**Microsoft Outlook** followed by Lotus Organizer and RedBox Organizer.

Of the whole lot, Microsoft Outlook was the odd one out because its interface is more like a straightforward office mail client. But it offers far more features than

the rest. This PIM-cum-mail client is only for users who want high features and have a mid- to high-end machine with plenty of RAM to spare.

Then comes the RedBox Organizer 4.0, with a neat interface showing off its features on the opening menu itself, just like a well-designed Web page. It also includes a world globe in the package, which tells the time zones, the current time in different cities all over the world, and the time taken to travel from one place to another. Lotus Organizer scores the most when it comes to user-friendliness.



Feature-rich winner all the way

However, it lacked integrated features such as a mail client and a phone dialler. Electronic Assistant needs a face lift and needs to improve on the currently amateurish look on the main interface.

Epoch Organizer and Cute Organizer are low-end PIMs which do not offer any huge features but are compact in size. **d**

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